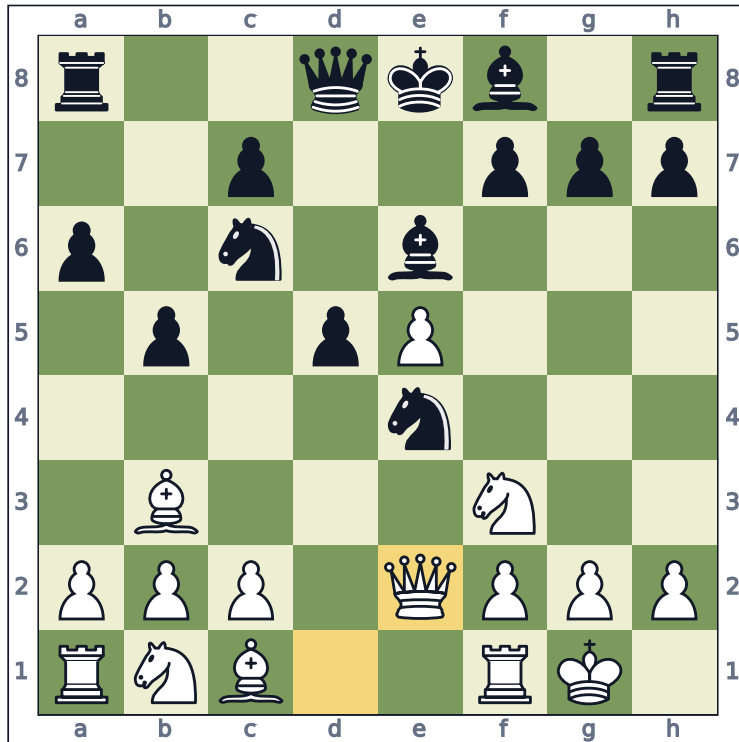


ITALIAN GAME, RUY LOPEZ, AND RELATED OPEN GAMES

Ruy Lopez

ECO C81 | 3 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.16 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Active and tactical: both sides must calculate forcing moves before following a thematic plan.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C81 covers Ruy Lopez. White develops with pressure on e5 while Black builds a secure center and seeks the freeing ...d5 break. The diagram uses the featured line Ruy Lopez: Open, Howell Attack.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Nxe4 6. d4 b5 7. Bb3 d5 8. dxe5 Be6 9. Qe2

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Castle, prepare d4, improve the least active piece, and preserve pressure rather than forcing tactics that are not ready.

BLACK'S GOALS

Defend e5 efficiently, challenge the center with ...d5, and use queenside or kingside activity according to White's structure.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

d4 and ...d5 define most transformations. c3 often supports d4; ...c5 may challenge a closed center.

PIECE MAP

The bishops on c4/b5 and c5/b4 shape development. Rooks become active on e- and d-files after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

The position can look quiet while tactical pressure accumulates on e5, f7, and along central files. The word 'attack' is a name, not a guarantee; complete development before forcing matters.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on d5, White pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Elite, fully sound opening territory. It rewards patient improvement as much as concrete calculation.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C81 line

This section preserves all 3 names and defining routes assigned to C81 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Ruy Lopez: Open, Howell Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Nxe4 6. d4 b5 7. Bb3 d5 8. dxe5 Be6 9. Qe2

002 Ruy Lopez: Open, Howell Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Nxe4 6. d4 b5 7. Bb3 d5 8. dxe5 Be6 9. Qe2 Be7 10. c4

003 Ruy Lopez: Open, Howell Attack, Ekstrom Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Nxe4 6. d4 b5 7. Bb3 d5 8. dxe5 Be6 9. Qe2 Be7 10. Rd1 O-O 11. c4 bxc4 12. Bxc4 Qd7